



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

śrutvādau yogaśāstrāṇi gurum ārādhya bhaktitah | BRP235.004.1

itihāsam purāṇam ca vedāṃś caiva vicakṣaṇaḥ || 4 || BRP235.004.2

āhāram yogadoṣāṃś ca deśakālam ca buddhimān | BRP235.005.1

jñātvā samabhyased yogaṃ nirdvandvo niṣparigrahaḥ || 5 || BRP235.005.2

— Brahmapurāṇa, Chapter 235: Description of the practice of Yoga (Chapter 235), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Brahmapurāṇa, in its discourse on Yoga, begins by emphasizing the necessity of foundational knowledge and devotion. It tells you that before embarking on the yogic path, you must diligently listen to and study the yoga scriptures. This isn't merely about intellectual understanding; it's about imbibing the spirit of Yoga through dedicated learning. Crucially, this verse highlights the importance of honoring and serving your guru with devotion. The guru serves as a beacon, illuminating the path and guiding you through the intricacies of the practice.

The scripture expands on the required knowledge base, including familiarity with history (itihāsa), ancient narratives (purāṇa), and the essence of the Vedas. This holistic approach underscores that Yoga is not an isolated practice, but rather an integral part of a larger spiritual and cultural tapestry. A discerning individual, according to the Brahmapurāṇa, also needs to understand the appropriate diet (āhāra), potential pitfalls (yogadoṣāṃś), and the influence of place and time (deśakāla) on their practice. This reveals the practical and nuanced nature of Yoga, emphasizing that it's not a one-size-fits-all approach.

In our modern world, where instant gratification and quick fixes are often prioritized, this verse offers a timely reminder to slow down and cultivate a solid foundation before diving into any spiritual pursuit. It urges you to seek qualified teachers, immerse yourself in the relevant texts, and become aware of the environmental and lifestyle factors that impact your well-being. The injunction to be free from duality (nirdvandvo) and non-possessive (niṣparigrahaḥ) highlights the importance of cultivating inner peace and detachment, essential qualities for successful yogic practice and a fulfilling life. By understanding these principles, you can approach Yoga with wisdom and discernment, making it a transformative force in your life.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what area of your life could a more dedicated period of learning and preparation lead to a more profound and beneficial outcome?